

DevOps Series

Ansible Deployment of RabbitMQ

RabbitMQ, which is free and open source, is the world's most widely deployed message broker. It is used by several big companies like Ford, Instagram, Cisco, etc. Being easy to deploy, it can be used in situ or on the cloud.



In this fourth article in the DevOps series, we will learn to install RabbitMQ using Ansible. RabbitMQ is a free and open source message broker system that supports a number of protocols such as the Advanced Message Queuing Protocol (AMQP), Streaming Text Oriented Messaging Protocol (STOMP) and Message Queue Telemetry Transport (MQTT). The software has support for a large number of client libraries for different programming languages. RabbitMQ is written using the Erlang programming language and is released under the Mozilla Public License.

Setting it up

A CentOS 6.8 virtual machine (VM) running on KVM is used for the installation. Do make sure that the VM has access to the Internet. The Ansible version used on the host (Parabola GNU/Linux-libre x86_64) is 2.2.1.0. The `ansible/folder` contains the following files:

```
ansible/inventory/kvm/inventory
ansible/playbooks/configuration/rabbitmq.yml
ansible/playbooks/admin/uninstall-rabbitmq.yml
```

The IP address of the guest CentOS 6.8 VM is added to the `inventory` file as shown below:

```
rabbitmq ansible_host=192.168.122.161 ansible_connection=ssh
ansible_user=root ansible_password=password
```

Also, add an entry for the `rabbitmq` host in the `/etc/hosts` file as indicated below:

```
192.168.122.161 rabbitmq
```

Installation

RabbitMQ requires the Erlang environment, and uses the Open Telecom Platform (OTP) framework. There are multiple sources for installing Erlang — the EPEL repository, Erlang Solutions, and the zero-dependency Erlang provided by RabbitMQ. In this article, we will use the EPEL repository for installing Erlang.

```
---
- name: Install RabbitMQ server
  hosts: rabbitmq
  gather_facts: true
  tags: [server]

tasks:
  - name: Import EPEL GPG key
    rpm_key:
      key: http://dl.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/RPM-GPG-
KEY-EPEL-6
      state: present

  - name: Add YUM repo
    yum_repository:
```